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GENERAL LEDGER

Version 3.5.2

Product Guide



FRONTISPIECE

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This manual relates to:

General Ledger Version 3.5.2

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Glossary



Glossary

Account Code

The unique code given to every account, consisting of one to four levels of a maximum twelve characters, as defined by the account's ledger, and used for all fiscal transactions.

The term given to the first twelve characters of the account and the last thirty characters of the extension code together.

Account Hierarchies

You can link accounts within the General Ledger in a hierarchical structure. Postings to accounts at the base of the hierarchy will automatically be posted to accounts within the structure. Accounts higher in the structure summarise postings at lower levels. Any account not at the lowest level in a hierarchy must be a memorandum account.

Adjustment

An entry made in accounts which does not record a transaction but which is made so that the accounts will present a true and fair view of the financial position. It includes entries which correct errors, entries for depreciation, bad debts and accrued expenses.

Adjustment Period

A period at year-end which is used for adjustment postings.

Alternative Year End

You can maintain two separate year cycles in General Ledger - Fiscal and Alternative. This allows you to set up two sets of year-to-date balances per account. It also involves having two year-ends. The alternative year-end is usually specified as being different from the fiscal year-end where it is necessary to produce a set of accounts for a parent company operating with a different financial calendar.

Analysis Code

As Extension Code.

Analysis Group Code

In order to use the payment analysis facility, analysis codes are set up by the user (or, in the case of 1099 users, supplied with the system). It is these codes which are entered when postings are made against suppliers.

Application Menus

A menu is a screen listing the functions available so that you can choose those functions to run your General Ledger. You can tailor menus to your specific requirements.

Application Reference Data

This is the basic data set up by the user without which the application cannot function - for example, Chart Of Account details, or currency codes.

Apportionment

See Budget Apportionment.

Apportionment Journal

This journal is used to transfer the value accumulated in one account to a series of other accounts in a ratio which has been defined.

Archive

Facilities are provided whereby redundant or old data can be removed from the system. Archived data will normally be held on either magnetic tape or cartridge. It can be restored for enquiry and report purposes.

Audit Trail

A sequence of connected pieces of evidence demonstrating how a figure in financial statements being audited has been derived from original transactions.

Bank Account

An account on your Chart Of Accounts which has been defined as a bank account to which transactions will be posted.

Bank Currency

The currency in which a bank account is held. A bank account may be held in only one currency.

Base Currency

When setting up a new company a base currency must be specified. The primary accounting currency of your organisation, normally your national currency, in which your statutory accounts are held. This is the currency into which any non-base currency will be converted for the purposes of enquiry, reporting and accounting. Once postings have been made to the company the base currency cannot be changed, so it must be decided with care. If an external application such as the Accounts Payable application is linked to a General Ledger, its base currency must be the same as that of the General Ledger.

Budgets And Forecasts

You can hold many different budgets/forecasts for your company's accounts. For example, optimistic, pessimistic and mid-view budgets. Reports and enquiries select budget and forecast records.

Budget Generation

A means of copying budgets or actuals - or a combination of the two - to a range of target accounts. You can specify a factor, to increase or decrease values by a percentage before they reach the target accounts.

Budget Apportionment

A means of apportioning a value across a range of accounts, according to specified factors.

Budget Spreading

A means of resspreading values already in budgets, according to specified factors.

Cash-Based VAT

VAT payable once payments from your debtor have been made.

Chart Of Accounts

The set up of ledgers and their accounts which are needed to satisfy the financial and management accounting requirements of your company.

Company Profile

The General Ledger is a multiple company application and a number of parameters for each of its companies must be set up before the application can be run. The company profile contains all the basic rules within which a particular company is to operate.

Consolidation

A procedure by which you can post the results of a source company into the accounts of a controlling or parent target company.

Constant Journal

A journal which contains a list of account codes to which values are attached.

Contra Accounting

A trading partner may often be both a supplier and a customer. Where this is the case, the contra accounts facility establishes a link between the supplier and customer accounts. This link causes an Accounts Payable payment to be reduced by the amount in the contra account in Accounts Receivable.

Control Account

A control account holds values posted from all the accounts of a sub-ledger beneath it. It cannot be posted to directly.

Control Value

A total value entered to ensure that all debit values for a batch of documents have been entered correctly. For a general journal this is the sum of all debit dissection values.

Conversion

The process by which values in transaction currency are expressed in base or bank currency. For example, a Deutschemark payment may be converted into base currency of a US dollar General Ledger, and into an ECU bank account.

Cost Allocation Journal

A journal which allocates costs from a range of source accounts to a range of target accounts based on the contents of a range of factor accounts, which are used to factorise them.

Country Code

Depending on where it is used, the country code may either control which international/ options are available to users, or it may simply control the format of the bank account window to appear when entering bank details.

Cross-ledger Level

As X-ledger Level. A ledger level which spans two or more ledgers in a company's Chart Of Accounts.

Currency Code

In General Ledger you can define a default currency to a company as its base currency. If you are running General Ledger in a multi-currency environment, a transaction may be entered in any currency defined to the system. Each currency is identified by a three character code with provided default exchange rates. There is an international standard currency code (ISO 4217). You need not use the code, but it would be sensible to do so.

Currency Transaction

Any financial transaction where its currency is entered as part of the transaction data. The currency of the transaction may be the base currency of the ledger.

Data Cube

When uploading PC spreadsheets to the AS/400, the spreadsheets or worksheets are sent to data cubes within data warehouses. These locations give the spreadsheets an address, so the user can find them on the AS/400.

Data Warehouse

Location on the AS/400 where data cubes are held.

Default

A default value is a value stored by the system for use when no other value can be found. For example, when setting up extension codes for an account, you

have the option to specify default codes which will appear in the extension code window whenever the account is entered.

Dissection

The breakdown of a single transaction value across a number of General Ledger accounts or VAT codes.

Effectivity

It is often useful to be able to define the validity dates of an entity, so that the system can prevent its use outside of these dates. This period of validity is called an entity's effectivity.

EU

European Union.

Euro Situation

The Euro and IN currencies are considered to be Euro zone currencies. A conversion between them involves fixed rates. This is referred to as a Euro situation.

Euro Transition

The phase of the introduction of the Euro currency. This is planned to be between January 1999 and July 2002 when it will become fully operational. Euro notes and coins are planned to be introduced in January 2002.

Exchange Rate

The number of units of one currency which may be bought or sold for one unit (or, in many cases, 100 units) of another currency.

Exchange Rate Code

The code set up to define the exchange rate between two currencies. The rate by which a value in one currency is converted or translated into the equivalent value in another currency. For example, if the source value is 1,000.00, and the rate is Divide by 2.5, the target value is 400.

Target value=Source value / rate

Source value=Target value x rate

Rate=Source value / Target value



Note: Exchange rates may be expressed as multiply by or divide by. For example, either

Target=Source / 2.5

or, Target=Source x 0.4

Extension Level Codes

Up to 5 possible levels defined by the ledger structure for the purpose of more detailed analysis of account values.

Fiscal Accounts

General Ledger accounts used to calculate the value of profit and loss of your company. (See also Memorandum Accounts.)

Flag

A flag is a trigger used to activate or deactivate facilities and parameters within an application.

Forecasts

Forecasts are set up and maintained in exactly the same way as budgets. Any reference to budgets is intended to include forecasts.

Frozen Hierarchies

Hierarchy rules which have been set up but not yet released into the system for use.

General Journal

A set of double-entry postings to the General Ledger, other than journals posted from external applications. (See also Journal Types.)

Generation

As Budget Generation. A means of copying budgets or actuals - or a combination of the two - to a range of target accounts. You can specify a factor, to increase or decrease values by a percentage before they reach the target accounts.

Global Level Codes

These are codes set up within levels which are reserved against like extension levels across all accounts within a company.

Hierarchies

See Account Hierarchies.

Hierarchy Rules

Rules which allow you to specify ranges of accounts, periods and percentages for the mass creation of hierarchies.

Historical Data

Application data which has been archived (meaning it is no longer considered current data), but which is retained (usually on tape), and may be restored for enquiries and reports.

IN/OUT

Currencies which join the Euro are known as INs. Currencies which do not join are known as OUTs. IN/OUT here refers to a currency conversion from a source IN currency to a target OUT currency.

Inter-Company Accounting

You can flag any company as having inter-company status within the General Ledger. Having done so, you can link your company with other such companies within the same application. When posting transactions to another company, you merely have to specify that company's code and process the transaction in the normal way.

Key Accounts

A set of accounts basic to the needs of the company and specified while maintaining the company profile.

Ledger Levels

Each ledger is made up of levels, which define the structure of the ledger's accounts. A ledger may have up to four account levels and five extension levels.

There are several types of level:

Global levels - extension levels which are reserved across all levels within a company

X-ledger levels - levels which cross two or more ledgers in a company's Chart Of Accounts

Ledger levels - levels which are defined for a single ledger

Level Codes

Each account is made up of level codes depending on how the account's ledger is defined. An account may have a maximum of four account level codes of up to nine characters each, and a maximum of five extension level codes of up to fifteen characters each.

There are several types of level codes:

- Global level codes
- X-ledger level codes
- Sub-ledger level codes - codes which are defined for accounts within a single ledger
- Account level codes - codes which are defined for a single specified account's extension levels. (Not to be confused with the general term for account codes).

See also Report Level Codes.

Linked Levels

A link set up between levels within a ledger to allow you to create combinations of related level codes.

Management Report

A report in a user-defined format, which prints accounts and totals from a single ledger.

Mandatory

Information which must be entered.

Manual Payment

The posting facility to record manual payments which have already been made other than through Miscellaneous Creditors.

Memorandum Accounts

General Ledger accounts which are not used to calculate the worth or profit and loss of the business. (See also Fiscal Accounts).

Miscellaneous Creditor

A supplier who is not paid through the Accounts Payable application but by a separate payment procedure in either the Cash Management or the General Ledger application.

Movement %

A limiting percentage range beyond which the fluctuations of exchange rates between currencies must not pass.

Multi-Company

A General Ledger structure which is designed to control more than one independent company or several companies reporting to a controlling or reporting company.

Multi-Currency

Trading in several currencies, linked to a single currency or multi-currency General Ledger.

Open Item

An open or outstanding item is an item which has been authorised but not yet fully paid.

OUT/IN

Currencies which join the Euro are known as INs. Currencies which do not join are known as OUTs. OUT/IN here refers to a currency conversion from a source OUT currency to a target IN currency.

Outstanding Item

An open or outstanding item is an item which has been authorised but not yet fully paid.

Page Up And Down

Keys used for the purpose of viewing the next screen (or page) of details. Keys on standard keyboards being marked Page Up and Page Down. Sometimes known as Roll Up and Roll Down.

Parameter

A characteristic or constant factor defined by you or already in the system, which determines the specific form or specific limitations of a function.

Payment Analysis

This function enables you apply analysis codes to payments made to suppliers, and to report on such payments. The facility has a particular use in the USA, where notifying the government of payments to contractors is a legal requirement and is referred to as 1099. The use of the function is decided by a flag when setting up the environment of a company - it is not a flag on the company profile.

Period

The units into which a financial year is divided for accounting purposes (usually 12 or 13). These are the same for each financial application linked to the General Ledger.

Period Close/Open

The procedure which completes the processing for the current period. The next period may then be opened.

Posting Inhibit Flag

A flag set up for an account which prevents the direct posting of journal transactions. It is either user-defined or set automatically by other procedures.

Prime Currency

The prime or transaction currency is the currency in which a transaction is made, as opposed to the Base Currency, into which transaction values will be converted.

Protocol Gap

Gaps in the sequence of protocol numbers held in a register.

See Register.

Protocol Number

The sequential number allocated to a VAT transaction in a register.

See Register.

Rate Code

See Exchange Rate Code

Register

Used in Italy. A register holds each VAT transaction with an allocated protocol number for the production of statutory reports.

Report Control Codes

These are used to create a sequence of values to appear in a report.

Revaluation

The change in the amount stated in the accounting records as the value of assets, following a valuation of those assets.

Reversing Journal

A journal posting values into an account in a financial period which reverses the effect of an adjusting entry made in a preceding period.

Also Reversal Journal.

Rolling Up Budgets

Using the user-defined links option you can link detailed, low-level user-defined views to higher level views. Then, any update to budgets in the low-level view will automatically appear in budgets in the high-level view. This is called rolling up.

Rule (Budgeting)

Within the budgeting module, a rule is a set of instructions which tells the system what budgets or values to use as the source of a new budget, and how to operate on the source values to produce the target budgets. Creating a rule does not create budgets; the processing is done after the rule is created.

Session

When starting to enter transactions, the system automatically sets up a session number. All transactions entered at once will then be part of that session. The session is the principal method of control in transaction processing, and provides the information required to satisfy audit requirements.

Source Currency

A currency you are converting or translating from.

Spread Budgets

See Budget Spread.

Spread Journal

A journal with a list of account codes, each with a spread factor. At the time of posting, an actual value is entered which is posted to the accounts in the specified ratios.

Spread Profile

A set of ratios for accounting periods by which annual budget or forecast values may be phased.

Standing Journal

A journal consisting of a skeleton of account codes to which values are posted as and when required.

Statistical Amount

You can post a statistical amount, such as a quantity, to each account for each period, either on a general journal or a statistical journal. The accumulated amounts are available on reports and enquiries

Sub-ledger

A sub-ledger contains accounts which accumulate into a control account at a higher level.

Suspended Journal

An incomplete journal which has been held. You can recall and complete suspended journals at any time.

Target Currency

A currency you are converting or translating into.

Tax Group

The USA government requires that sister companies be grouped together in the 1099 report so that their payment analysis figures are consolidated. This group is called a tax group.

Total Entry

The Total Entry facility in the budgeting module compares actuals to an existing budget, then displays the variance, enabling you to enter totals - that is, change the recommendations - yourself, before creating the budgets.

Transaction Currency

Same as Prime Currency. The currency in which a transaction is recorded, and normally applied to transactions in other than the base currency.

Transaction Matching

A procedure by which you can allocate corresponding debit and credit transactions on an account to one another. Matched transactions are then invisible for enquiries and reports.

Translation

The expression of financial data in terms of a different currency from the base currency in which they were stated. Or, the process by which base currency account balances in one General Ledger are expressed in the different base currency of another General Ledger.

Trial Balance

A report which prints the net value posted to each top level account (excluding memorandum accounts) for a selected period and year-to-date. It also confirms that the ledger is in balance.

Triangulation

During the Euro transition phase, currencies which are participating must be calculated in a three point format known as triangulation. The source currency value is converted to an interim Euro value which is, in turn, converted to the target currency value. See also the Euro Currency Maintenance option.

1099

See Payment Analysis

Unmatched Details

Cleared payments where the payments have been amended.

User-Defined Link

A specified path for rolling up budgets. See Rolling Up.

User-Defined View

A defined number of account levels arranged in any order you want and used for enquiry, report and budgeting purposes. User-defined views are also known as user-defined keys.

VAT Accounting

The way in which Value Added Tax is posted, recorded and accounted for. See Value Added Tax in General Ledger for more details.

VAT Registers

This is a facility to enable the production of VAT reports based on tax area. The codes are set up in General Ledger by the user, and relate to a particular tax office. This facility will be used mainly in Italy.

Worksheet

When a spreadsheet is uploaded from PC to the AS/400, it is referred to as a worksheet.

X-Ledger Level

A ledger level which spans two or more ledgers in a company's Chart Of Accounts.

X-Ledger Level Codes

Account codes set up within X-ledger levels so that they can span two or more ledgers in a company's ledger structure.

Year Close Journal

A journal which collapses values in both Profit & Loss accounts and Balance Sheet accounts into respective summary accounts before automatically running a year open journal for the start of the new financial year. Also known as Year End.

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